Coaching takeaways: Mark

Based on the October 13, 2026 session and patterns from coaching and call reviews since September · 2-minute read

Key realization: Use the playbook, but make it your own, and keep every claim approved. Ask questions before you pitch, use what they tell you, and close with a specific time.

Stop

- "Ken came across your practice," "Ken wants to meet you," "Ken asked me to connect with you." (9/1 to 10/6)
  Client call reviews flag these on most dates. Use the approved lines.
- "More leads than we can handle." (9/1 to 9/25)
  Not approved. You've improved here, so keep it out.
- Pitching after a clear no. (9/22, 9/29, 10/2, 10/13)
  Ask an open question, or thank them and end politely.
- Repeating "very important business matter" or saying "this is an outreach call." (10/13)
- "You got two minutes?" and "Would it be worth 20 minutes?" (10/13)
  Both give them an easy no.
- Vague purpose: "I want to evaluate..." or "We're not here to make changes." (10/13)

Continue

- Your confident, conversational tone. (9/24, 9/29, 10/13)
- Active listening and thinking on your feet. (10/13)
- Polite, clean exits when they decline. (9/29)
- Checking the calendar live and confirming date, time, time zone and email. (10/13)
- Handing payout and money questions to the team. (10/13)

Start

- Before you dial: check the exact name in GHL. (9/28 to 10/6)
  Recent reviews found many calls asking for the wrong name.
- "Take me off your list" = mark Do Not Call in GHL right away. (9/29, 10/1)
  Reviews found opt-outs that were not logged and then redialed.
- "Are you approved by our broker-dealer?" Give a clear no. (10/2)
  "No, we're an independent RIA, not affiliated with [firm]."
- Qualify first, then: (10/13)
  "That's exactly why I'm calling." Then: Are you free [day] at [time], or would [time] work better?
- After a gatekeeper transfer, ask for their direct line. (10/13)
  Say you'll send an invite and call 5 minutes before.
- Update your tracker every day. (10/6)

Lines to keep on your screen

Gatekeeper, "Is she expecting your call?" "No, she isn't expecting my call. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. It's about her practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."

Prospect, "What's in it for me?" "Fair question. Our founder has built and sold a few firms, so he's been on both sides of these decisions. The call is to understand where you want your practice to go, and to show you options that could fit. There's no commitment. Are you free [day] at [time], or would [time] work better?"

Prospect, "I'm good." "That's great to hear. Out of curiosity, how many more clients could you take on right now?"

Closing "I'll send you a calendar invite right after this call, and I'll call you 5 minutes before. What's the best direct number to reach you?"

Every answer: **answer** their question, **add** one line of context, then end with a **request or open question**. Only say what's true, and only use approved facts. Dates in gray show when the pattern came up.